

Addicts generally get called names such as ‘spammer’, ‘lamer’ and ‘n00b’ (short for newbie). Other very colourful names and variants of those names are also thrown about at random by the majority. This happens because members see the same people butting in everywhere with comments or questions, very often in threads or topics that they know nothing about, when in fact they would be better off waiting and reading posts by members who do have the knowledge to reply.

Just as we hate chatterboxes in real life, who never let you finish a sentence and interrupt you all the time, addicts tend to be disliked by the majority.

Troublemakers

The terrorists of the online world, troublemakers have only one agenda—to disrupt everyday life on a forum. These people will do absolutely anything to shock and repulse members, and even enjoy the abuses hurled at them.

Unlike in real life, where such people can be caught and punished, anonymity in the online world is not hard to come by. Forums are not made to be fortresses, and whatever security measures are taken are hardly a deterrent to a troublemaker.

Sometime in late 2004, the *Digit* forum was attacked by a few such troublemakers: some were intent on spreading hate, others were trying to hack the forum, and one even went as far as posting filthy abuse and pornography. Thankfully, our members were mature enough to ignore it all, and recognised the immaturity and pointlessness of the troublemakers.

No matter how many IPs were banned, and how many e-mail addresses blocked, the troublemakers returned. In the end it was the members of the forum that got rid of these unwanted few. How? Just by ignoring everything they did. Nothing hurt more than the lack of confrontation and the sheer indifference they were shown.